



various environments and climates, from mountains to beachfronts, deserts to hills. The cars are possibly the best part of the game, with such beauties as the Bugatti Veyron Grand Sport to the McLaren F1. There

are plenty of cars to unlock, but no real garage to speak of – you get to pick from unlocked cars for the relevant series (Performance, Super, Hyper, etc.).

You can choose any car you've unlocked for 'Free



Pros

- Credible, non-jazzy graphics
- Glorious cars
- Top-notch multiplayer

Cons

- Unrealistic, simplistic controls
- No customization
- No performance tuning

Verdict

Buy! This is no racing simulation, but a non-stop powered-up ride that tests your gutsiest moves from Career to Multiplayer as a racer, and hones your seek and destroy instincts as a cop.



Roam'ing the 100+ miles of the county's road, but don't hope to chase down racers or do some running yourself in Single Player mode, that's only for Multiplayer.

The player has seven different types of events to choose from in Career mode: Race, Duel (between racers), Preview (time trial of a yet unlocked car), Gauntlet (time trial with cops chasing you), Hot Pursuit, Time Trial, Rapid Response (cop time trial), and Interceptor (one felon vs. one cop), the last two of which are meant to be played as a cop.

Racers in Hot Pursuit and Gauntlet events have access to up to 4 weapons to be used 2-3 times within an event against rivals and cops – including EMP, Jammer, Spike Strip, and Turbo. While Turbo is defensive, you can still ram cops or rivals with it. As a cop, your weapons are mostly the same, though you can also unleash road blocks

and helicopters (to drop spike strips ahead of the leader).

NFSHP's Autolog is a new feature that will soon see the light of day again in Shift Unleashed. It's your racing social networking platform, allowing you share your victories and photos, compete against friends on a track-by-track leaderboard, or keep up with the latest news from NFS. This in itself is perhaps not too exciting if you aren't the social type, but worth trying, you might just find yourself excited about beating your friend's best time on a particular track, or showing off pictures of a particularly spectacular takedown.

While Autolog is all about being connected, you can enjoy the game offline as well. Do that, become good, and then dialup – NFSHP's multiplayer is its ultimate selling point, there is nothing better than playing cops vs racers with real egos at work. **D**